

THE FUND FOR PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

ANNUAL REPORT 2024 - 2025

Supporting Excellent Education for Students in Portland Public Schools

WHO WE ARE

The Fund for PPS is an independent nonprofit organization dedicated to raising philanthropic funds and forging strategic partnerships to support Portland Public Schools, its students, and families. Established in 2019, The Fund harnesses the generosity of Portland's community to strengthen opportunities for every student to experience inclusive, joyful, and rigorous learning.

In fiscal year 2024-25 The Fund for PPS's total investment — $1.4 million dollars — is living up to that vision.

For example, our signature campaign, Champion PPS Schools, designated $930,000 in parent-fundraised dollars for high impact tutoring, math supports, and food pantries to advance academic achievement and support students throughout the 2025-26 school year. And, additional Fund for PPS investments supported an array of programming and services, from visual and performing arts to clean "green" student transportation.

With strong support for public education in our city, we believe now is the time to accelerate our momentum. We're inviting community members—from families to business leaders to philanthropic organizations—to rally in support of all our students.

The Fund for PPS is...

- Investing in academic achievement
- Uniting community districtwide
- Fundraising for future success

BOARD OF DIRECTORS 2024 - 25

BELIEVING IN THE POWER OF PUBLIC EDUCATION AND THE BRILLIANCE OF STUDENTS

"I'm passionate about ensuring every child has access to fundamental needs: a safe environment, nutritious food, health care and quality education with strong literacy support. When we work together to provide these essentials, we give our children a solid launch pad for building their futures." — **Kelly Huotari,** Vice President of Employee Communications, Cambia Health Solutions

"Maintaining a strong Portland Public School district that is committed to excellence, is critical to the long-term strength and resilience of Portland's economy. Youth are the future leaders and innovators who will carry the city and the state forward for generations to come. The Fund for PPS has an important role to play keeping PPS strong and accelerating improvement in public education for our students. I'm so pleased to serve on this Board and have this opportunity to do my part for PPS."
— **Jon Isaacs**, Executive Vice President, Public Affairs, Portland Metro Chamber

"I learned from my grandparents, who were both educators, that strong teaching and equitable access to quality learning can change the course of a child's life. That's why I push for us to act boldly — every one of us has a role in making schools stronger for kids. — **Dr. Christine Pitts**, President and CEO, Open School

"I'm a proud Portlander, PPS graduate and PPS parent. I believe that schools are positive spaces where we can all get together around the shared value of excellent education and its ability to enhance the civic life of our community." — **Collin Romer**, Chief Communications Officer, Portland Timbers

"Education has always been at the heart of my journey — as a student, a scientist, a leader, and as a self-proclaimed nerd who believes deeply in the power of lifelong learning. The opportunities I've had were made possible because communities have invested in schools, and I believe we owe the same to every student. Serving with The Fund for PPS is one way I can give back, ensuring that every Portland student has the chance to learn, grow, and thrive." — **Dr. Jackie Wirz**, Executive Director, Link Oregon

Special thanks to **Eddie Wang**, Chair of the PPS Board of Education, for serving as an Ex Officio Board member in the 2024-25 school year!

TOGETHER, WE RISE



Greetings! It is my pleasure to serve as an Ex Officio member of the Board of Directors for The Fund for PPS and to share with the broader community my pride in our accomplishments as a school district.

We are transforming lives. All over the district, in 81 sites, there are so many stories to lift up. Did you know that attendance is up overall for all student groups? Yes it is! Did you know in the 2024-25 school year students completed more that 5,600 Advanced Placement exams — the most in our history? Yes they did! More than 12,000 students participated in Career & Technical Education, with 95% of them graduating on time. And, 450 students earned an industry recognized credential.

The Fund for PPS + PPS partnership is so important. The Fund's campaign, Champion PPS Schools, launched over the year covered in this report, is unifying parents and the community to pool fundraising and support crucial activities to advance students' academic achievement. With a total investment in PPS of $930,000, Champion PPS Schools has contributed $660,000 to High Impact Tutoring (HIT) for the 2025-26 school year. This is just the type of evidence-based support that we know will help our students get to grade-level literacy, and beyond. "HIT" has taken root in our classrooms — with amazing results. You may have seen news coverage of this promising practice. Districtwide, participating students achieved 28% growth on skills needed to read at grade level. Data collected on 85 students across four schools offering High Impact Tutoring record that 80 of them showed double-digit growth, while one fourth of them showed triple-digit growth.*

I hope you'll join me in recognizing the great work of PPS students and join The Fund for PPS's movement to advance excellence in our schools. When more donors become Champions and contribute to this campaign, together we'll expand The Fund's ability to advance literacy and math skills, provide direct assistance to families and more! Together, We Rise!

Growth is what is anchoring us. This isn't the finish line — we're just getting started!

Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong
Superintendent, Portland Public Schools

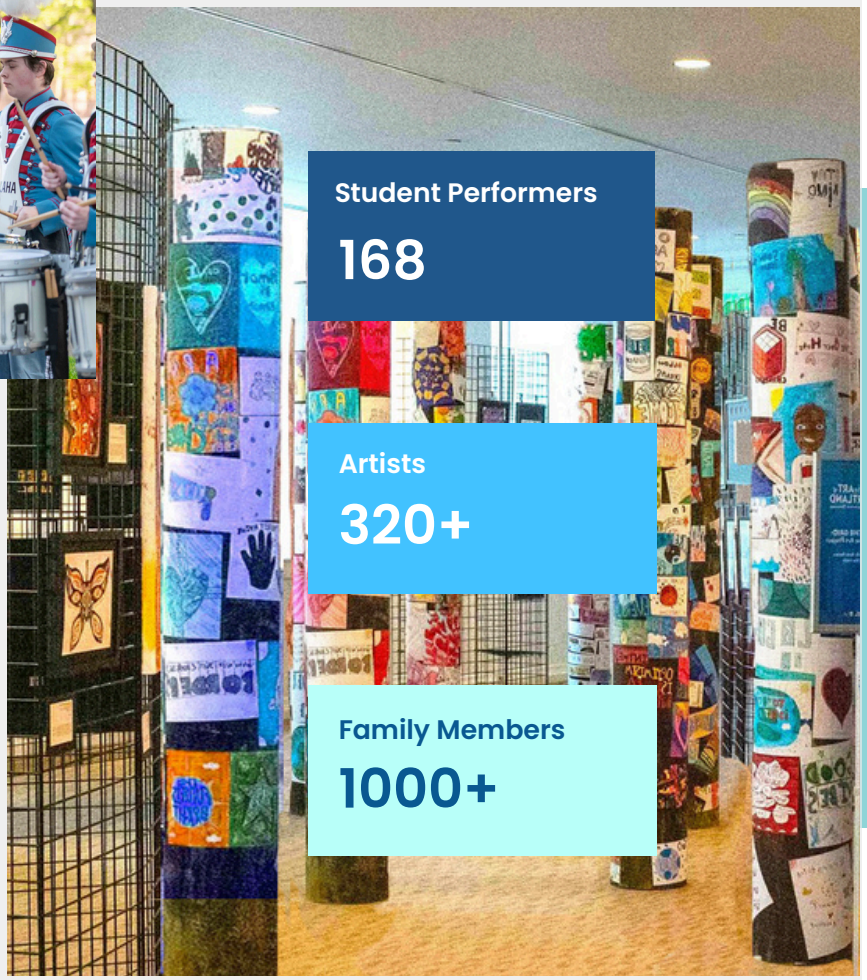
*Silverman, Julia. "In Portland, intensive reading tutoring delivers eye-opening results, propels some children to grade-level in months." Oregonian, June 7, 2025.

SUPPORTING ARTS IN PPS

For the third year, The Fund celebrated Visual & Performing Arts and arts learning by supporting the annual HeART of Portland event at the Portland Art Museum. Thanks to our corporate sponsors and to the 168 student performers, 120 student visual artists plus the 200+ artists represented in the collaborative project, and more than 1,000 family members and guests who attended.







Student Performers
168

Artists
320+

Family Members
1000+

The HeART of PORTLAND

IMPACT

CHECK OUT THE IMPACT OUR INVESTMENTS ARE MAKING ACROSS PPS



GOING GREEN!

The Fund received two more PGE electric school bus grant awards in 2025! We're helping PPS reach net zero GHG emissions and phase out fossil fuel infrastructure by 2040. And, did you know that grants for EVs don't just result in cleaner air for our students to breathe and provide a smooth, quiet lift to school, they also advance teaching and learning? The electric buses The Fund has helped secure grants for are regularly visiting schools and PPS events and being used as tangible, real-world case studies for student investigations of climate science and environmental sustainability.

CARING FOR OUR PPS COMMUNITY!

In keeping with our belief in the importance of providing direct support to PPS families facing extreme financial hardships, The Fund has continued to work with school social workers to reach families in need. These dedicated staff have close collaborative relationships with PPS families in our 20 Community Schools.

"In our schools, there has been a sharp increase in families needing support with food and other basic needs. We are grateful for the recent donation through The Fund for PPS that has provided gift cards to support families with food, hygiene items, and other household necessities. And we all know that meeting families & students' basic needs is essential to learning and success in our classrooms."

– Dr. Karmin Williams, Director of Community Schools, PPS





COLOR SPLASH ON RIGLER CAMPUS!

Through a generous corporate sponsor secured by The Fund, Rigler Elementary was able to collaborate with Ideal PDX/Latino Artist Exchange to achieve their school community's dream of a visually compelling mural to brighten their schoolyard. As they posted on Instagram, "Rigler Elementary has become a more joyful place."

UNITING COMMUNITY TO SUPPORT SCHOOLS!

The Fund for PPS was a proud supporter of Portlanders for Safe and Healthy Schools, the $1.83 billion Portland Public Schools bond!

Thank you to the Portland voters for passing this important measure in May 2025!

YES FOR Portland Schools
RENEW • REPAIR • MODERNIZE



RUBY BRIDGES DAY AT BOISE-ELIOT/HUMBOLDT ELEMENTARY!

The Fund for PPS and Board of Education Directors joined Superintendent Armstrong for "Ruby Bridges Walk to School Day" at Boise-Eliot/Humboldt Elementary School. The Fund for PPS purchased 115 copies of the book *I Am Ruby Bridges* for students to take home.

LAUNCHED!

COLLECTIVE IMPACT

"The sum of us is greater than any one of us."
Superintendent Kimberlee Armstong

This collective spirit is why The Fund for PPS launched Champion PPS Schools. The Parent Advisory Committee (PAC) for the Distribution of Donations for Staffing, a group of nine parents and two students, analyzed priorities and ways to make the most impact. With $1,030,000 to allocate for the 2025-26 school year, the PAC recommended the following investments that were then approved by the PPS Board of Education on May 6, 2025:

High Impact Tutoring for K-3rd grade students	$660,000
Math Supports for 9th - 10th grade students	$ 70,000
Food Pantries in 20 Community Schools	$200,000
Total Investment in PPS for 2025-26	**$930,000**

The PAC also allocated $100,000 for The Fund for PPS to use as *"Seed Funding for Future Fundraising."* This seed funding will be utilized for marketing and fundraising efforts in order to engage PPS families and the broader community in supporting Champion PPS Schools!

JOIN US TO STRENGTHEN AND EXPAND CHAMPION PPS SCHOOLS

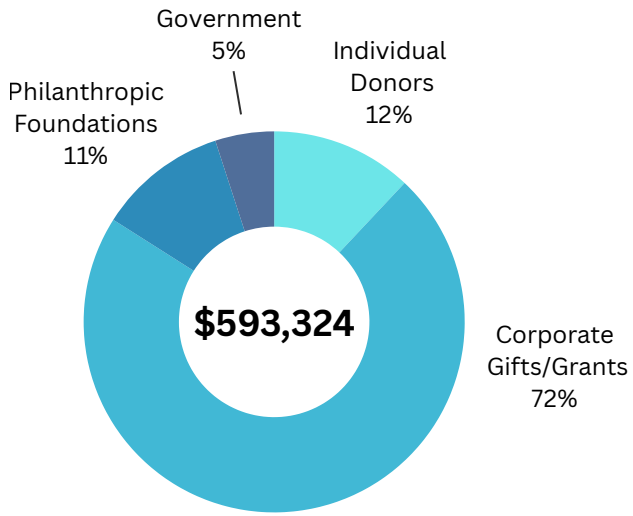
We are seeking to broaden involvement in the Champion PPS Schools campaign to include active participants from all PPS school communities. It's simple: If we increase donations to Champion PPS Schools we can make a difference in the lives of more PPS students.

Our ambitious goal is to fundraise more than $1 million dollars by June 30, 2026 for the 2026-27 school year to expand High Impact Tutoring and other student supports. The more we fundraise, the greater our reach. Together, we're helping students take flight!

FINANCIALS

Revenue

In addition to the Champion PPS Schools campaign, The Fund for PPS actively raises resources via grant seeking, corporate sponsorships and through individual donations. These monies are often restricted to or designated for a specific purpose by the donor or grant program. The Revenue wheel shows the sources of such funds in 2024-25.



Expenses

Expenses detail specific program investments benefitting PPS students, The Fund's Advocacy expenditure (a donation to support the recent Bond campaign), and the standard nonprofit expenditure categories 'Management' and 'Fundraising.'

Program	$507,489	**82%**
Investments Benefitting PPS Students		
PGE Electric School Bus Grants	$354,114	
Donations to Targeted Programs	$114,875	
Direct Assistance to Families	$38,500	
Advocacy	$30,000	**4%**
Management	$41,179	**7%**
Fundraising	$41,518	**7%**
TOTAL	**$620,186**	

Financial Summary

Beginning Fund Balance (as of 7/1/2024)	$262,007
Revenue (7/1/2024-6/30/2025)	$593,324
Expenses (7/1/2024-6/30/2025)	($620,186)
Ending Fund Balance (as of 6/30/25)	**$235,145**

TOTAL GIVING 2024 - 25

The Fund for PPS awarded $1,437,498 to Portland Public Schools in 2024-25. These investments are making a direct impact in our schools through the Champion PPS Schools' focus areas — High Impact Tutoring, math supports for 9th and 10th grade, and food pantries — ***and*** through a variety of other programming for students. For example, The Fund put clean, quiet electric buses 'en route' to PPS schools, staged the HeART of Portland showcase with the PPS Visual & Performing Arts Team, helped a school contract and collaborate with artists to paint an inspirational mural, brought the books to Ruby Bridges Day, provided direct assistance to PPS families — and more.

2024 - 2025

Total Program Investments

Programming for Students	$507,489
Champion PPS Schools	$930,000
~Awarded May 2025 for 2025-26	
Total	**$1,437,489**

THE FUND FOR PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

THANK YOU PARTNERS

PGE Project Zero

NEW SEASONS MARKET

CAMBIA health foundation

TheStandard

nwea believe in what's possible

OCF JOSEPH E. WESTON PUBLIC FOUNDATION
A Supporting Foundation of Oregon Community Foundation

Thank you to all of our donors and supporters for your trust and belief in the potential of all Portland students. Together we are building a movement that advances excellent instruction and elevates the academic experience of all our students.